First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office:
Tuesday-Friday, 9am-2pm
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: Friday 9:30am -12:30pm
Monday is Pastor Jessica's Sabbath.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Reader: Louise Haynes
Acolytes: Sophia Gagnon, Kaia Newton, Mykala Pryor, and Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans
An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

June 1, 2025

10 am

Reverend Jessica Moore, Pastor
Bailey Brown, Music and Choir Director
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Stephen McLaughlin, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Seventh Sunday in Easter June 1, 2025

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words

A mind is like a parachute. It doesn't work if it is not open.

— Frank Zappa

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *God of Earth and Sea and Heaven* S. Conrady

Welcome and Announcements

Sung Call To Worship *Bless the Lord, My Soul* (Taizé)

Bless the Lord, my soul
And Bless God's Holy name
Bless the Lord, my soul
Who leads me into life.

Morning Prayer[1] (unison)

Creator, be with us as we live into all that is possible. You sent us Jesus to show us the value and dignity and beauty of all people. You created the change of seasons as a reminder of the beauty of our planet. We were not made sinful by design, as so many interpretations go – You created us in Your image with the capability of loving so vastly and so greatly that healing and reconciliation are possible. Amen.

Hymn*

To You, O God, All Creatures Sing (1,2,4) NCH 17

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!

If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).

If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

* Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Greg Beeman Thank You for the continuing Ministry of FCC's monthly Open-Mic Night!
- Mary Bostwick, Alice Drislane, Carol and Doug Klette, Rich Guzman, and Chauncey Scates (the Welcome Home Team!) Thank You for all your hard work, which keeps WH going!

UNDERSTANDING PALESTINE: A Community Conversation
TODAY (June 1) from 2 to 4 P.M.
St. Paul's Methodist Church - 11 Church St., St. Albans

June 7 Pride Celebration
Volunteers wanted to help person FCC's information table in Taylor Park AND to help with an Open-House at the church.

June 8 Ecumenical Prayer Walk - 1 P.M. at Taylor Park

June 14 - All Church Picnic
Noon-4pm @ The Browns' Camp in Swanton

Zoom Bible Study: Companionship on the Road
Wednesdays 7:00-8:00pm
June 4: Acts 2 : 1-21
Please ask Pastor Jessica for the link.

Online Giving:
Wi-Fi (Sanctuary):
Sanctuary123



Prayer of Transformation[1]

Creator, we have been led astray by the systems that promote individuality, greed, absolutism, and patriarchy. We know that You forgive us because You invite us into new birth again and again. You invite us to embody new understandings of collectivity and new ways of acting in and towards the world – to be witness to the evils of patriarchy and supremacy and the politics of people and ask us, instead, to give gratitude and love. Be with us as we change to become more of what You ask us to be – joyful in the journey towards reparation and true Grace.

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Anthem *Thanksgiving Eve* by Bob Franke
Arr. Peter Amidon

Scripture Reading
Luke 24: 44-53

Contemporary Reading
Ascension Steve Garnaas-Holmes

Morning Reflection

Hymn*
Let Us Break Bread Together NCH 330

THE COMMUNION

All the parts of this shared meal together come from the Earth.
The seeds of grain grew with patience, tenderness and love.
They were then gathered and milled into a loaf to be shared communally.
The grapes used in this cup were also grown with patience, tenderness and love.
They were gathered by the hands of migrant workers and pressed into juice to be shared communally.
We were reminded at the start of Lent this year that we, too, are from the Earth and that with patience, tenderness, and love we find ourselves here collectively willing to partake of elements that are meant to spark a new type of living in the world.
Creator be with us all.
Many: We remember
the land from which we came
One: Lift up your hearts

Many: We remember
the patience and tenderness needed

One: Lift up our hearts
Many: We remember
the sacrifice You made to help us believe
One: Lift up our hearts.

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass

against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

Blessing and distribution of the Bread and Cup:
Please hold your bread and juice until all are served, so that we may eat and drink together.

Prayer of Thanksgiving

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns
Pastor's Prayer~

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

Lord, Dismiss Us with Your Blessing NCH 77

Benediction

Postlude *When Stephen, Full of Power and Grace*
S. Conrady

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖